PassFrame
TUITION

The Old Clock

Year 4 — 11+ Mark Scheme (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension · Mark Scheme

For tutor use. Accept any well-reasoned answer supported by evidence from the extract, even if it differs from the wording below.

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

1. In the hallway.

2. The poet's father and mother.

3. “It chimes each hour, deep and slow…”

4. Accept any 2 of: “its golden hands that never rest”; “a patient voice that never shouts”; “it watched my father.”

5. That the clock's chime is calm and unhurried.

6. False — the poet says they have “always loved to know” the sound.

7. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. to show how the clock has been present throughout generations of the family's history.

8. Sits on the stair and listens to the clock.

9. The poet hopes their own children will one day listen to the clock, just as they and their parents did.

10. That the poet feels fondness and reluctance to let go of the clock, or of the past it represents.

11. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. a clock naturally represents the passing of time across generations.

12. Accept any reasoned personal answer.

Homework Worksheet — Answers

1. Golden.

2. Ride her first bicycle.

3. “It chimes each hour, deep and slow.”

4. “I sit upon the stair.”

5. That she rode unsteadily, wobbling from side to side.

6. Correct order: the clock watching the poet's parents as children → the clock's chime being described → the poet sitting and listening on the stairs → the clock's future with the poet's children.

7. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. to emphasise the clock's reliability and constant presence over many years.

8. Keeps ticking (tick-tocks on).

9. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. to show hope that family traditions and memories will continue.

10. That the clock's presence across generations is central to the poem's meaning about family and time.

11. “loath.”

12. Accept any reasoned, imaginative personal answer.